Figure 14.3 Kustomize bases can be used as the foundation for further customizations (overlays) depending on the deployment environment.

Bases and overlays can be defined either in the same repository or different ones. For the Polar Bookshop system, we'll use the k8s folder in each application project as a base and define overlays in the `polar-deployment` repository. Similar to what you learned in chapter 3 about application codebases, you can decide whether to keep your deployment configuration in the same repository as your application or not. I decided to go for a separate repository for a few reasons:

- It makes it possible to control the deployment of all the system components from a single place.
- It allows focused version-control, auditing, and compliance checks before deploying anything to production.
- It fits the GitOps approach, where delivery and deployment tasks are decoupled.

As an example, figure 14.4 shows how the Kustomize manifests could be structured in the case of Catalog Service, having bases and overlays in two separate repositories.